Public Transparency & Accountability

USCN-POL-004 | v1.0 (clarified 20 Oct 2026) | Original approval: 19 October 2026 | Revisions approved: 20 October 2026 where applicable | Effective: 20 October 2026 for revisions | Owner: DPO

Approved original policy provisions (19 October 2026)

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USCN-POL-004 | Version 1.0 | Approval draft

1. Purpose and scope

This policy sets out how USCN provides clear and proportionate public information about its CCTV operations, receives and responds to enquiries and complaints, demonstrates accountability and maintains accurate public-facing material. It applies to USCN personnel, authorised contractors and relevant hosting arrangements. It supplements USCN-POL-001, USCN-POL-002 and USCN-POL-003 and does not replace legal rights or statutory duties.

2. Core transparency commitments

USCN will make reasonably accessible information about its public-safety purpose, identity as data controller, privacy notices and lawful basis, individual rights, contact routes, recording retention and disclosure principles, complaints procedures and proportionate network performance information. It will explain governance arrangements and distinguish the status of material that is planned, in preparation, under review, approved but unpublished, published, or effective. A statement that a document is approved must not be treated as proof of publication.

3. Camera-specific public information

USCN will provide proportionate camera-specific summaries, subject to privacy, confidentiality and security limitations. Summaries may describe the camera's purpose, general area, relevant privacy arrangements and an appropriate contact route. USCN need not publish exact security-sensitive configurations, administrator details, network architecture, [redacted]

4. Signage and camera identifiers

Appropriate signage must be positioned visibly and reasonably before entry to a monitored area and before operational recording begins. It should identify USCN as operator and controller, explain the main purpose, and give an accessible contact route and a web address or QR code. Where deployed, the QR code or URL will direct to the relevant camera's unique-identifier page at transparency.uscn.org.uk. Hosts must not obstruct signage and should notify USCN of damage, removal or obstruction; responsibility for lawful transparency remains with USCN. Signage suitability is checked before commissioning and following relevant changes.

5. Public websites and publication

The central public transparency resource is transparency.uscn.org.uk, including links to relevant camera-specific information and other USCN resources. datahandling.uscn.org.uk is a separate data-handling resource, not the default camera-signage QR-code destination. Documents are published when approved and ready for public release, without a fixed publication deadline. An approved document may remain unpublished. Publication status and effective status are recorded separately; this policy becomes effective upon its formal approval, even if public publication follows later.

6. Public enquiries and press

USCN accepts general network and camera enquiries; privacy and data-rights requests; footage requests; complaints and objections; reports of inaccurate public information, damaged signage or faults; and media enquiries. Designated personnel triage routine matters. The DPO leads or oversees privacy rights, sensitive disclosures and matters reserved to the DPO. Statutory requests must be handled within applicable legal deadlines; routine enquiries are answered as resources reasonably permit, without promising a universal turnaround. Significant enquiries, complaints and statutory requests are recorded proportionately. Footage disclosure remains subject to USCN-POL-002 and DPO controls.

7. Press routing

Transparency-related press enquiries: press@transparency.uscn.org.uk. General network or data-handling press enquiries: press@datahandling.uscn.org.uk. Commercial press enquiries: press@uscn.uk. Mixed-topic press enquiries: press@org.uscn.uk. Routing an enquiry to a press mailbox does not authorise disclosure of footage, personal data or confidential security information; applicable approvals and checks still apply.

8. Complaints and objections

USCN will accept concerns about privacy intrusion, camera placement and viewing angle, signage, recording or security, rights and disclosure, and conduct of personnel, contractors or hosts. Designated staff assess and log complaints; the DPO leads privacy and data-rights matters. Where appropriate, USCN may explain its purpose and safeguards, reassess the camera-specific DPIA, adjust masking, field of view or signage, correct inaccurate information, suspend or withdraw a camera, or escalate serious issues. Where contact details exist, USCN will acknowledge the complaint and provide a proportionate outcome response, subject to confidentiality and legal constraints. A complaint does not automatically require footage disclosure or camera removal.

9. Governance and accountability

Management is accountable for organisational transparency commitments. The DPO oversees privacy, individual rights and reserved disclosure or camera-related decisions. Authorised staff maintain public information, route requests and implement approved corrections. Hosts cooperate with reasonable signage arrangements and report obstruction or damage but do not determine USCN's data protection duties. Material privacy changes require DPO consideration before implementation. Significant transparency decisions, complaints and corrective actions must be documented proportionately.

10. Public reporting and safeguards

USCN may publish meaningful updates when material developments warrant them, without committing to annual or quarterly reporting. Public accountability information may include aggregate statistics on complaints, footage requests and disclosures, together with relevant governance and correction arrangements. Reports and summaries must minimise re-identification risk and withhold personal data, security-sensitive details and confidential information where appropriate. Aggregate reporting does not override statutory confidentiality or individual rights.

11. Accuracy, corrections and review

Public information is reviewed when material information changes, with additional checks where practicable. Identified inaccuracies or obsolete information should be corrected within a reasonable timeframe; material privacy implications must be referred to the DPO. USCN will inform affected enquirers or complainants where appropriate and record significant corrections and reasons. The policy is reviewed following material legal, operational, technology, deployment, complaint or governance developments rather than on a fixed annual cycle.

12. Exceptions and mandatory protections

Operational exceptions must be documented and risk-assessed by authorised personnel; DPO approval is required for privacy matters and decisions reserved to the DPO. Exceptions cannot override statutory obligations or safeguards expressly mandated in this policy: accurate and accessible information with proportionate correction; visible signage and camera-specific transparency links; lawful handling of rights, enquiries and complaints; DPO oversight of material privacy and disclosure decisions; accurate publication-status distinctions; and proportionate records of significant decisions, complaints and corrections.

13. Implementation and related documents

The policy takes effect upon formal approval. Following publication, existing public-facing materials should be aligned as reasonably practicable. The timing of publication does not change the approval or effective date. Relevant linked documents include USCN-POL-001 (CCTV Operations, Privacy & Data Protection), USCN-POL-002 (Footage Access, Disclosure & Retention), USCN-POL-003 (Camera Security & Technical Safeguards), USCN-LIA-001 (Legitimate Interests Assessment), camera-specific DPIAs and the planned USCN compliance register. References to policies or assessments do not imply that every referenced item has been published or that camera-specific DPIAs are complete.

14. Approval record

Approving authority: Data Protection Officer. Proposed approver: Bertram Scanlon. Proposed approval date: 19 October 2026. Approval confirmation/signature: pending. Effective date: the date formal approval is confirmed. Publication date: to be recorded separately when publication occurs. This is an approval draft and must not be presented as signed or formally approved until that confirmation is received.

Accessible request channels — clarification effective 20 October 2026

A subject access request may be made verbally or in writing. A camera ID, prescribed form, statutory citation or reason is not mandatory. USCN will assist with identifying relevant footage and request only proportionate additional information where needed.